

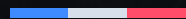
PARIS • 5 - 13 SEPTEMBER 2026

# The Eiffel Tower Incident

BAPS, SETE and the Reputational Intelligence Brief



A plain reading of the evidence, and of how the world's media is telling the story. What is established, what is disputed, and how the controversy is being framed across France, India and international media.



INDEPENDENT OPEN-SOURCE ANALYSIS

Evidence cut-off 13 September 2026

Not commissioned, funded, reviewed or endorsed by BAPS, SETE, any union, authority or media organisation. Compiled from published reporting.

COVER PHOTOGRAPH • L. DE COCKBORNE / BOBOSTUDIO • USED WITH CREDIT

*L. de Cockborne*  
BOBOSTUDIO

UPDATE · 29 SEPTEMBER 2026

# The investigation has reported

*An operational failure by the operator — and its director general will step down*

- SETE’s internal investigation found “**operational flaws and shortcomings**” in organising the 5 September visit that led to the “**unacceptable**” removal of female staff.
- Patrick Branco Ruivo, director general of SETE since 2018, **will leave at the end of 2026**. Chair Ariel Weil has requested gender-equality measures and training programmes, and will prepare the leadership transition.
- This is the first hard institutional consequence. It places operational responsibility on the **operator, not the visitors**. What the request said word for word, and who inside SETE approved it, remains unpublished.

## SUPERSEDES THE 13 SEPTEMBER EVIDENCE CUT-OFF

Sources · France 24, BBC, Indian Express, WION — 29 September 2026

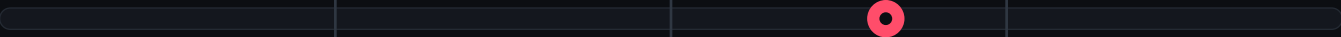
This page updates the brief after its 13 September snapshot. Independent analysis from published reporting. Not commissioned, funded, reviewed or endorsed by BAPS, SETE, any union, authority or media organisation. The cover date reflects the original compilation window.

# The core fact is settled, and it closed against BAPS

SETE, the tower operator, confirmed the request itself. The question is no longer whether this happened. It is what exactly was asked, and who is responsible for how it was delivered.

|                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What happened    | A BAPS delegation of about 100 visited on Saturday 5 September, tied to the temple consecration the next day. Female staff, including subcontractors, were told to leave posts or avoid certain zones. In some posts men replaced them.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Confirmed        | SETE stated BAPS asked for a visit limiting interactions with women, and that these conditions should not have been accepted. An admission against its own interest, which makes it strong evidence.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Disputed         | The exact wording. Written or verbal. Who asked, who approved. Whether BAPS requested removal, or requested reduced interaction and SETE chose removal as the method.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Since 9 Sep      | India's MEA formally distanced the government (“a matter purely between the entities concerned”). The story then split: it unites French politicians but divides the Indian diaspora, and a racism-against-Indians angle opened. Then, from 10 September, a counter-narrative in BAPS's favour: the mayor of Bussy-Saint-Georges praised BAPS's decade of local conduct while calling the tower episode “not acceptable”, and a 43-nation diplomatic open day was held at the Mandir, both carried by the IANS wire and Indian outlets, not the French mainstream. |
| Biggest exposure | The BAPS statement is non-responsive. “No one was denied access” addresses visitor access. The allegation is about employees being moved. Journalists have noticed.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

## WHERE THE EVIDENCE CURRENTLY SITS



|                                                                                                 |                                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Accommodation, badly executed</b><br>BAPS asked for reduced interaction; SETE chose removal. | <b>Request to exclude women</b><br>A workplace arranged around employees' gender. |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

|                                                                                                                |                                                                                                          |                                                                                                 |                                                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| REPUTATIONAL<br><b>High</b><br>Wire-carried into 20+ markets in 72 hours. Frame confirmed by the counterparty. | LEGAL<br><b>Medium</b><br>Employment duty sits with SETE as employer. BAPS exposure secondary, unproven. | COMMUNICATIONS<br><b>High</b><br>The published response does not address the actual allegation. | ESCALATION<br><b>Med-High</b><br>Two investigations pending. Any document restarts the cycle. |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

|                          |                              |                            |                           |                             |
|--------------------------|------------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------|
| <b>5 Sep</b><br>INCIDENT | <b>1 day</b><br>TOWER CLOSED | <b>2</b><br>INVESTIGATIONS | <b>30</b><br>OUTLETS READ | <b>High</b><br>OVERALL RISK |
|--------------------------|------------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------|

## 02 · TIMELINE

# A private visit became a national controversy in 72 hours

Red markers are the moments the trajectory changed. The four newest entries carry the story past the incident itself.

|             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ● WED 3 SEP | <b>BAPS ceremony at the tower's foot, then a Seine parade</b><br>Photographed by AFP, uncontroversial at the time. The imagery is now reused to illustrate the row.                                                                                                                |
| ● PRE-VISIT | <b>The visit is arranged with SETE, terms still unresolved</b><br>No public evidence of the date, channel, wording or authorship of the request. The largest evidentiary gap.                                                                                                      |
| ○ SAT 5 SEP | <b>The visit. Female staff moved off posts, replaced in some cases by men</b><br>About 100 people at the start of opening hours. Instructions covered employees and subcontractor staff.                                                                                           |
| ● SAT 5 SEP | <b>Indian Alliance Paris holds a press meeting on BAPS, hours before the visit</b><br>A critical frame was already circulating among French journalists and the union before the incident.                                                                                         |
| ● SUN 6 SEP | <b>Temple consecrated at Bussy-Saint-Georges. Modi addresses by video</b><br>The rite was men-only, relayed to ~7,000. Modi has said nothing about the Eiffel Tower.                                                                                                               |
| ○ MON 7 SEP | <b>Staff vote to strike. The tower closes for the day</b><br>Union wording: women sidelined, replaced and made invisible because of their sex. A letter used discrimination sexuelle.                                                                                              |
| ○ MON 7 SEP | <b>SETE confirms the request and says it should not have been accepted</b><br>An admission against its own interest, weighted up accordingly. The narrative frame locks here.                                                                                                      |
| ● MON 7 SEP | <b>BAPS Paris responds on X</b><br>Says the arrangement was logistical, coordinated for the group's size, and that no one was denied access. Apologises for hurt.                                                                                                                  |
| ○ 7-8 SEP   | <b>Political condemnation across the spectrum</b><br>Gregoire: absurd, iniquitous, unacceptable. Berge: no dogma above the laws of the Republic. Two investigations ordered.                                                                                                       |
| ○ TUE 8 SEP | <b>India's MEA distances the government from the row</b><br>A matter purely between the entities concerned. The Indian state removes itself as a defender. New.                                                                                                                    |
| ● TUE 8 SEP | <b>Braun-Pivet and Chaturvedi raise the institutional level</b><br>The National Assembly President and a Shiv Sena (UBT) MP both criticise. The Indian voice is personal, not governmental. New.                                                                                   |
| ○ WED 9 SEP | <b>The story splits: French unity, diaspora division, a racism warning</b><br>France 24: the row unites French politicians but divides the Indian diaspora. A backlash-against-Indians angle opens. New.                                                                           |
| ● 10-11 SEP | <b>Indian-language coverage turns critical; community response scales</b><br>OpIndia's Gujarati and English editions both treat it critically; the Gujarati piece says the sect must not shift its rules onto society. New.                                                        |
| ● 10 SEP    | <b>43-nation Indo-French Cultural Open Day at the Mandir</b><br>Hosted by India's Permanent Delegation to UNESCO. Surfaced 12 Sep via the IANS wire and a BAPS release, not the French press. New.                                                                                 |
| ○ 12-13 SEP | <b>Counter-narrative: the mayor defends BAPS; inquiries still pending</b><br>Mayor Dubosc praises BAPS's decade of local conduct and calls the tower episode not acceptable, awaiting the Paris inquiries. The wire version omits the incident. Neither inquiry has reported. New. |

## 03 · NARRATIVE COMPARISON

# The strongest case each side can make

Arguments paired by theme and scored one to four on evidentiary strength, not on how persuasive they sound. Blue is the case for BAPS, red the case against. Analyst coding, open to challenge.



11

TOTAL, FOR BAPS

18

TOTAL, AGAINST

0

PRO ARGS SCORING 4/4

## The employer made the decision

SETE issued the instructions, apologised, and is the target of the investigations.

## The request was made at all

An organisation asked a French monument to arrange staffing around employees' gender. The counterparty confirmed it.

## A vow binds the monk, not women

Brahmacharya restricts the sadhu's own contact. Lay members are exempt.

## The consequence was foreseeable

At a staffed monument, limiting interaction with women can only be done by moving women.

## BAPS apologised within 48 hours

Public, and it did not dispute the staff's distress.

## The response missed the accusation

Nobody said visitors were turned away. The complaint was about employees.

The three strongest defences are about SETE, about doctrine, or about missing evidence. None of them says BAPS acted well.

04 · EVIDENCE POSITION

# Known, disputed, unknown

Twenty-four material facts, coded by evidentiary position. An empty box is not a defence: absence of a published document does not mean none exists.



Against interest: SETE's confirmation damages SETE, which is why it carries weight. Contradiction: a BAPS volunteer told AFP that saints have rules so men and women are separated, before the later gender denial.

## 05 · CENTRAL QUESTION

# Did BAPS ask for women to be removed, or ask for something SETE delivered that way?

This decides whether the correct description is a badly executed accommodation or a request to exclude women.

WAS A REQUEST MADE?

**Yes**

Confirmed by SETE. Not denied by BAPS.

DID IT REFERENCE WOMEN?

**Probably**

SETE's wording says so. BAPS denies. No document.

WRITTEN OR VERBAL?

**Unknown**

Nothing public. Investigations will likely establish it.

DID SETE ACCEPT?

**Yes**

Admitted. Approver not named.

WERE WOMEN MOVED?

**Yes**

Staff, works council and CGT agree. The tower stayed open to tourists, so women were moved off posts, not sent home.

DID BAPS FORESEE IT?

**Unknown**

No evidence either way. Most consequential open question.

A request to limit interaction and a request to remove women are not the same act. But at a staffed monument, the first can only be delivered by doing the second.

## Religious boundary vs workplace discrimination

A vow constrains the monk. It becomes something else when observance is delivered by changing another person's working conditions based on gender.

The vow is not misogyny. The implementation was still discrimination.

## Accommodation vs exclusion

An accommodation adjusts the practitioner. Routing monks through low-staffed areas would not have caused this. An exclusion adjusts other people.

What was delivered was an exclusion. Whether BAPS asked for an accommodation is unproven.

## Intent vs effect

The BAPS position is an intent argument. French law and opinion are effect-based. The staff statement is entirely about effect.

An intent defence does not engage an effect-based accusation.

## Who carries responsibility

The workplace duty sits with the employer, which is why the inquiries target SETE's internal approval.

Legal responsibility most likely sits with SETE. Reputational responsibility is assigned to both.

# Twenty-one items. Six original sources. One wire.

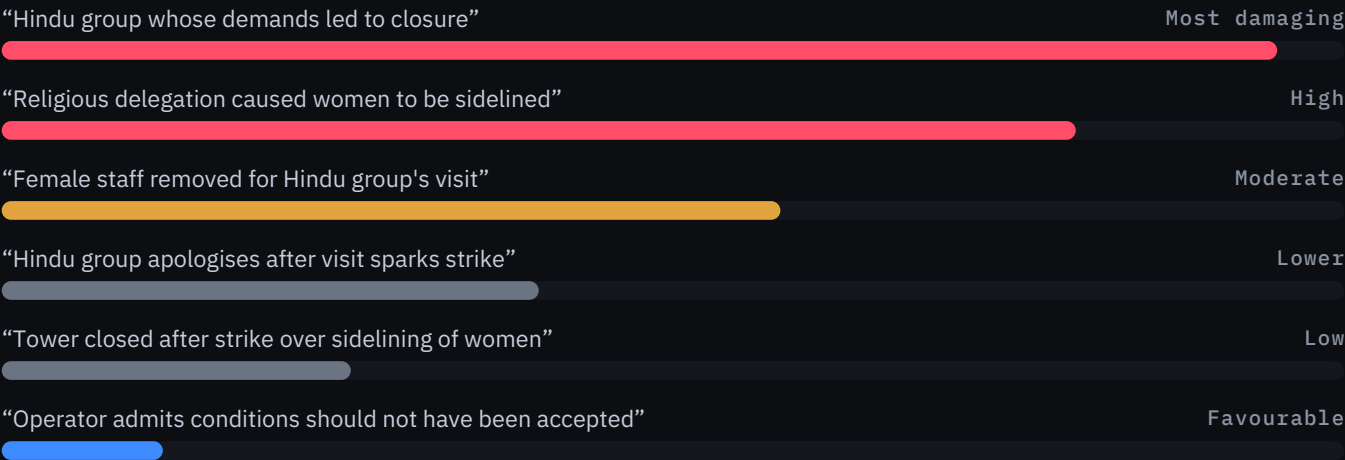
Not twenty independent investigations. A handful of originating accounts, amplified. Wide but shallow.



- Original reporting 6
- Wire republication 8
- Derivative / explainer 7

AFP produced most French and much international text. Reuters supplied the works-council interview; franceinfo obtained the staff letter. Ten outlets repeating one AFP paragraph is one source, not ten.

## HOW THE HEADLINE SHIFTS THE BLAME



## INDIAN, BROADCAST & EXPLAINER COVERAGE · ADDED 11 SEP

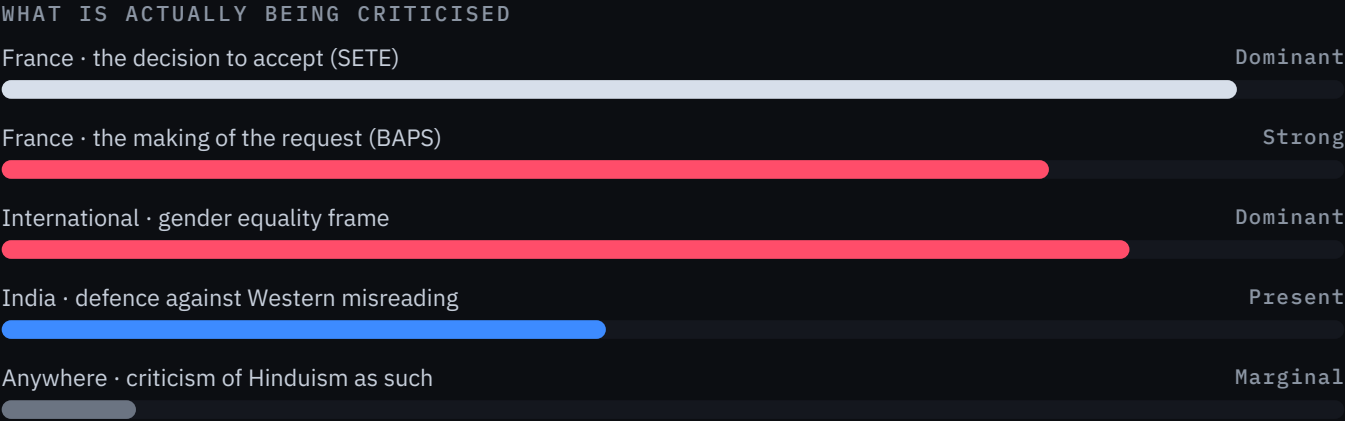
| OUTLET                    | ORIGIN | STANCE             | NOTE                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------|--------|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| OpIndia (EN & Gujarati)   | IND    | Critical           | Both editions treat it critically; the Gujarati piece says the sect must not shift its rules onto society. |
| Outlook / The Week        | IND    | Neutral            | Led on the government distancing rather than the incident.                                                 |
| Newslaundry / News Minute | IND    | Critical           | Own research into the vows and the political ties, not wire copy.                                          |
| France 24 (diaspora)      | FRA    | Investigative      | The most consequential piece published since 9 September.                                                  |
| RTBF / Euronews (TV)      | BEL/EU | Critical / neutral | French-language and pan-European broadcast. Followed the wire frame.                                       |
| Business Today TV         | IND    | Neutral            | Indian television explainer of the row and the protest.                                                    |
| Religion Media Centre     | UK     | Neutral            | Explainer. The most careful on the line between the vow and the workplace.                                 |



07 · SENTIMENT & STAKEHOLDERS

# Coded positions, with the source count visible

No polling exists for a four-day-old story. These are coded counts of identified positions, not measurements of public opinion.

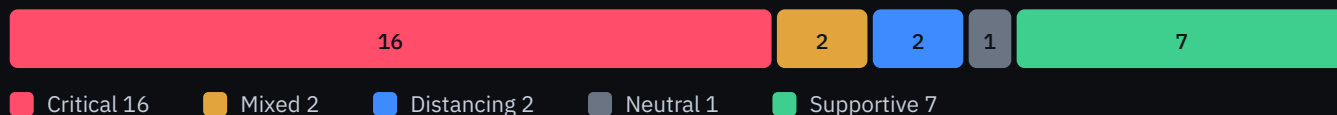


| STAKEHOLDER                  | CURRENT POSTURE     | WHAT DRIVES IT                                               |
|------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Eiffel Tower staff & CGT     | Opposition          | Direct experience. Now negotiating a written VIP framework.  |
| Works council (CSE)          | Opposition          | Wants guarantees, not apologies.                             |
| City of Paris                | Opposition          | Owns the monument. Two investigations running.               |
| French government            | Opposition          | Equality minister engaged, but used “if confirmed”.          |
| Ile-de-France region         | Concern, exposed    | Pecresse enabled the temple and attended festivities.        |
| French far right             | Instrumentalising   | Fits an existing religion-and-Republic frame. Do not engage. |
| BAPS devotees, global        | Support             | Reading the incident as a misunderstanding of practice.      |
| Indian diaspora, non-aligned | Split               | Criticism of BAPS conservatism predates this incident.       |
| Indian government            | Neutral, distancing | MEA called it a matter between the entities. A step back.    |
| Women's rights advocates     | Opposition          | A clear-cut case on their own terms.                         |

## 08 • VOICES &amp; STANCES

# Who is saying what, and where they sit

Twenty-eight named voices were mapped across four countries. The thirteen highest-signal are below. Almost every supportive voice is inside the BAPS community and almost every critical voice outside it; the exception is the mayor of Bussy-Saint-Georges, a French official who now defends BAPS while condemning the incident.



| WHO                   | CTRY   | STANCE              | WHY IT MATTERS                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------|--------|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ariel Weil            | FRA    | Conceded            | SETE said the conditions should not have been accepted. The counterparty's admission, strongest evidence in the file.                                                                    |
| Emmanuel Gregoire     | FRA    | Critical            | Mayor of Paris. Called it absurd and iniquitous, ordered two investigations. His inquiry is the next news event.                                                                         |
| Diane Davoine         | FRA    | Complainant         | Works council. The originating account, quoted in almost all global coverage.                                                                                                            |
| Yael Braun-Pivet      | FRA    | Critical            | National Assembly President. Raises the institutional level of the criticism. New since 9 Sep.                                                                                           |
| Randhir Jaiswal       | IND    | Distancing          | MEA spokesperson. "A matter purely between the entities." The most consequential shift since 9 Sep.                                                                                      |
| Mahua Moitra          | IND    | Strongly critical   | MP, TMC. The sharpest-worded Indian political voice; tagged the French embassy.                                                                                                          |
| Anish Gawande         | IND    | Strongly critical   | Opposition spokesperson. Highest-reach single critical post; some claims contested in its own comments.                                                                                  |
| Indian Alliance Paris | FRA    | Strongly critical   | Calls BAPS a retrograde sect, and warns the affair must not become a pretext for racism. Both halves matter.                                                                             |
| Sunita Viswanath      | USA    | Critical            | Hindus for Human Rights. Frames the critique as Hindu-led, which makes anti-Hindu counter-claims harder.                                                                                 |
| Jay Thadeshwar        | IND    | Strongly supportive | Non-member. Highest-reach post on either side (~70k likes). The "earliest lift" detail is unverified.                                                                                    |
| Women of BAPS (~20)   | GLOBAL | Supportive          | First-person posts, one above 4,900 likes. The most credible asset BAPS has; weakest in absolute claims.                                                                                 |
| Rashmi Samant         | IND    | Mixed               | Criticises and defends in the same piece: abroad, the host society meets the action, not the reasoning.                                                                                  |
| Yann Dubosc           | FRA    | Mixed               | Mayor of Bussy-Saint-Georges. Praises BAPS's decade of local conduct yet calls the tower episode not acceptable and awaits the inquiries. The first French official to defend BAPS. New. |

09 · DIASPORA & WHAT CHANGED SINCE THE 9TH

# The story has stopped being about one morning

Since 9 September the controversy widened along three tracks with little to do with the Eiffel Tower. Then, from 10 September, a fourth opened that cuts the other way: an organised BAPS reputation push.

TRACK 1

## Diaspora split

Indian groups in France are publicly divided. One side calls BAPS unrepresentative of Hinduism. The other is producing first-person defences at volume. A critique from Hindu organisations cannot be answered with a claim of anti-Hindu prejudice.

TRACK 2

## Racism risk

The French far right has taken up the story. BAPS's own diaspora critics issued the racism warning themselves. This is the track BAPS controls least and can lose most on without doing anything further.

TRACK 3

## Record revisited

Coverage has moved to the New Jersey labour case (US federal probe closed in 2025 without charges; civil suit continues) and to unproven land-allocation claims. Older material, new audience.

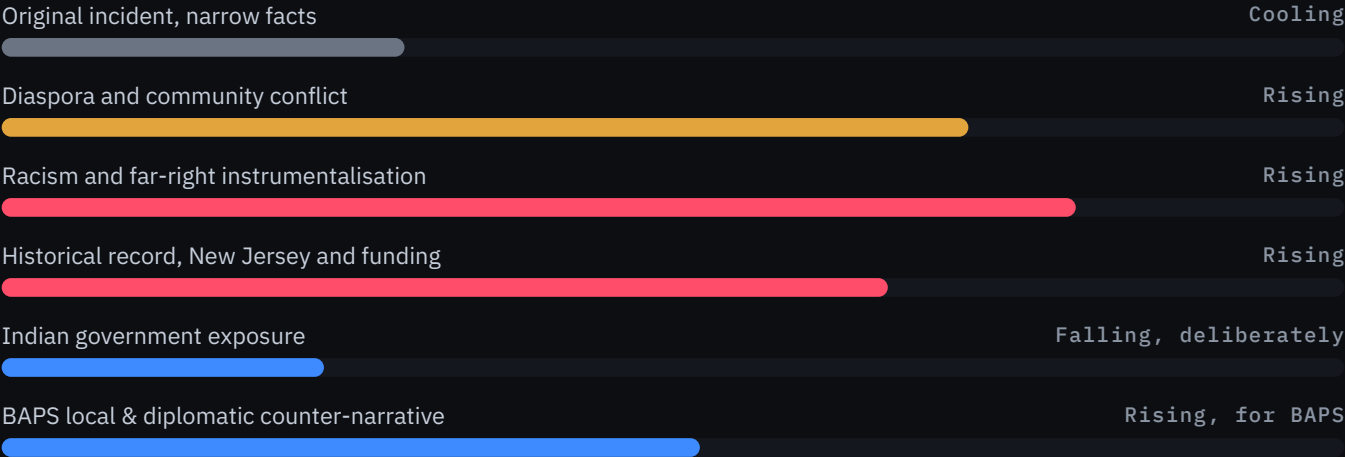
TRACK 4 · COUNTER-NARRATIVE (NEW)

## The mayor defends BAPS, and the mainstream misses it

Mayor Yann Dubosc praises BAPS's decade of transparent local conduct, yet calls the tower episode not acceptable, backs gender equality and awaits the Paris inquiries. A 43-nation Indo-French Cultural Open Day, hosted by India's Permanent Delegation to UNESCO, was also held at the Mandir. Both travel only through the IANS wire and Indian and diaspora outlets, not the French mainstream that drove the criticism; the wire version even recasts the confirmed incident as rumours.

WHERE THE RISK NOW SITS, COMPARED WITH 9 SEPTEMBER

Direction of travel to 13 September, analyst assessment.



The one line: the original allegation is cooling, the diaspora and racism risks are still warming, and BAPS finally has a counterweight, the mayor's defence and the diplomatic open day. But it travels only through Indian and diaspora wire copy; until the French and Western mainstream carry it, the positive context stays invisible to the audience that formed the judgement.

## 10 · LANGUAGE &amp; SENTIMENT

## Two vocabularies that barely touch

The finding is not what either side says. It is that they are not using the same words at all. The critical vocabulary is about effect on a third party; the supportive vocabulary is about internal meaning and intent.

## WHAT THE CRITICAL SIDE TALKS ABOUT

discrimination sidelined  
public monument  
laws of the Republic  
why visit at all humiliated  
double standard regressive  
egalite removed invisible  
far right workplace Hindutva

## WHAT THE SUPPORTIVE SIDE TALKS ABOUT

brahmacharya  
lived experience full picture  
service mother's prayer  
celibacy maryada  
misunderstanding  
not discrimination discipline  
respect empowerment  
boundaries proud

## WHY THE SPLIT MATTERS MORE THAN THE VOLUME

Share of reviewed terms falling into each frame.

Critical terms describing effect on staff

Dominant

Supportive terms describing intent and meaning

Dominant

Terms used by both sides

Narrow

Supportive terms that engage the effect argument

Very narrow

Method: analyst-coded term frequencies across roughly 60 items in four languages, plus named X and Instagram posts and their comment threads. No platform API was used. Treat the bands as directional, a reading of the reviewed material rather than a measurement of public opinion.

11 · CONTRADICTIONS & RISK

# Where the accounts diverge, and what would settle them

## Was the request about gender?

SETE: a visit limiting interactions with women. BAPS: never rooted in gender, about size.  
Better supported: SETE. If the concern were size, the instruction would have applied to all staff.

## Access vs displacement

BAPS: no one was denied access. Staff: women moved off posts, replaced by men.  
Both may be true. They answer different questions, and BAPS answered the easier one.

## Was the monument privatised?

BAPS: normal opening hours. Some commentary: privatised. No union or SETE statement describes a closure.  
One of the few places a BAPS clarification would be factually solid.

### RISK HEATMAP

|              | FRANCE   | INDIA  | INTL   | DEVOTEES |
|--------------|----------|--------|--------|----------|
| Reputational | Critical | Low    | High   | Low      |
| Legal        | Medium   | None   | Low    | n/a      |
| Political    | Critical | Low    | Medium | n/a      |
| Partnerships | High     | Low    | Medium | n/a      |
| Women        | Critical | Medium | High   | Medium   |
| Under-30s    | High     | Medium | High   | Medium   |
| Interfaith   | High     | Low    | Medium | Low      |
| Venue access | Critical | None   | Medium | n/a      |

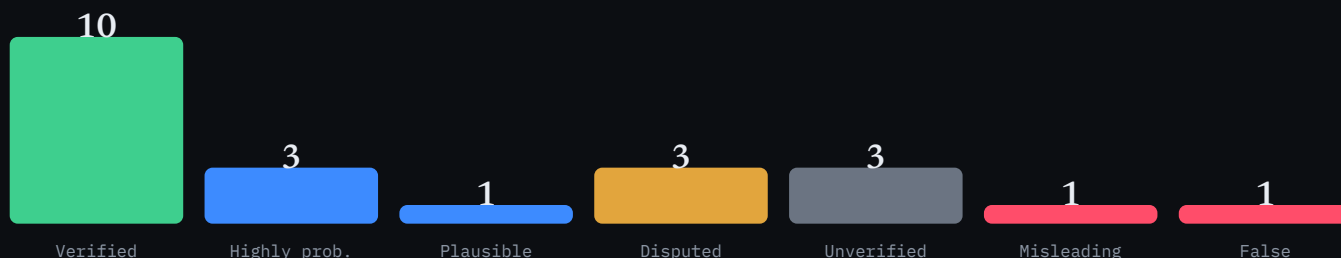
### WHAT WOULD CHANGE THIS ASSESSMENT

|                                                         |             |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Written request explicitly asking that women be removed | Much worse  |
| Written request with no reference to sex                | Much better |
| Evidence SETE proposed the removal method itself        | Much better |
| Testimony a BAPS organiser saw the displacement         | Worse       |
| A precedent at another public venue                     | Much worse  |
| Finding that SETE bore sole operational responsibility  | Better      |

## 12 · CLAIM VERIFICATION

## Key claims, assessed against the underlying source

Assessment reflects evidence strength, not whether a claim favours BAPS. Distribution across all twenty-two claims reviewed.



| CLAIM                                                   | SOURCE              | ASSESSMENT         |
|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------|
| Delegation of ~100 visited on 5 September               | CBS/Reuters, AFP    | Verified           |
| BAPS requested the visit limit interactions with women  | SETE to AFP         | Verified           |
| SETE accepted, later said it should not have            | SETE to AFP         | Verified           |
| Female employees asked to leave posts                   | CGT, franceinfo     | Verified           |
| Men replaced women at some posts                        | Staff stmt, Reuters | Highly probable    |
| Instructions extended to subcontractor staff            | franceinfo          | Highly probable    |
| Tower closed 7 Sep due to the strike                    | La Presse / AFP     | Verified           |
| BAPS apologised                                         | BAPS Paris on X     | Verified           |
| The request was never rooted in gender                  | BAPS Paris to CNN   | Disputed           |
| No one was denied access to the tower                   | BAPS Paris on X     | Verified as stated |
| Sadhu vows restrict contact with women (monks only)     | BAPS material       | Verified           |
| The 6 Sep rite was attended only by men                 | AFP on site         | Highly probable    |
| The request was made in writing                         | None                | Unverified         |
| BAPS knew women would be removed from posts             | Critical commentary | Unverified         |
| Women were prevented from working or lost pay           | Social media        | Misleading         |
| Modi commented on the Eiffel Tower incident             | Commentary          | False as stated    |
| Request was only to take the earliest lift (Thadeshwar) | Instagram reel      | Unverified         |

## 13 · WHERE THIS COMES FROM

# Every material claim traced to origin

All entries link to the article consulted in the interactive version. Reliability scale: 5 primary evidence, 4 official statement or direct interview, 3 multiple independent reports, 2 single report, 1 social claim.

|                    |                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary statements | SETE to AFP · BAPS Paris on X · BAPS Paris to CNN · staff statement via CGT · staff letter, franceinfo                                                                       |
| Named interviews   | Diane Davoine, works council · Denis Vavassori, CGT · Ariel Weil, SETE · BAPS volunteers to AFP                                                                              |
| Official reaction  | Mayor Gregoire · Aurore Berge · Valerie Pecresse · Yael Braun-Pivet · Marine Le Pen · India MEA                                                                              |
| Media reviewed     | AFP · franceinfo · Reuters · France 24 · Europe 1 · Public Senat · CNN · Bloomberg · Al Jazeera · IBTimes · OpIndia (EN & GU) · Outlook · The Week · Newslaundry · Organiser |
| Expert comment     | Christophe Jaffrelot, Sciences Po, quoted by AFP                                                                                                                             |
| Legal reference    | French Penal Code art. 225-1 to 225-4, Legifrance                                                                                                                            |

## SEVEN THINGS TO HOLD ON TO

- 1 The vow is real, and it binds the monk.**  
Brahmacharya restricts the sadhu's own contact. It applies to monks, not lay members.
- 2 A personal boundary became a workplace question.**  
At a staffed monument, a monk's boundary can only be delivered by moving women. That is the hinge.
- 3 The core fact came from the other side.**  
SETE said BAPS asked to limit interactions with women, and that it was wrong to agree. An admission against interest.
- 4 Real questions remain open.**  
Nobody has published the request's wording, who made it, or who approved it. Two investigations may answer.
- 5 The response created a second problem.**  
"No one was denied access" answers a question nobody asked. It reads as avoidance, and journalists noticed.
- 6 The ground shifted after the 9th.**  
India's MEA stepped back and the sharpest criticism now comes from inside Hindu and Indian organisations, which closes off the anti-Hindu framing entirely.
- 7 A counter-narrative has arrived, but only on the wire.**  
Since 10 September the mayor of Bussy-Saint-Georges has defended BAPS and a 43-nation open day was held at the Mandir, the first shift in BAPS's favour. It travels through the IANS wire and Indian outlets, not the French mainstream that set the frame.

## WHAT THIS DOCUMENT IS NOT

An independent reading of public reporting. Not commissioned, funded, reviewed or endorsed by BAPS, SETE, any union, authority or media organisation. Not legal advice. It is also not a defence document: where the evidence is unfavourable, it says so; where critics have overstated things, it says that too.

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